MENT 3235: Final Team Project

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Item	What to do
Team	Same five-person team and selected startup plan; four section authors and one Team Leader.
Deliverables	One report PDF and one 15-minute team pitch video. Use the video upload or link field already provided in HuskyCT.
Who submits	Each member submits a contribution summary in SkillSimm; the Team Leader coordinates the graded report and video submissions in HuskyCT/Blackboard.
Deadline	Keep the existing schedule: pitch video submission on December 8 and final report/video submission on December 15. The current HuskyCT assignment specifies the exact cutoff and which video version to submit at each milestone.
Report length	No new page or word minimum. Answer every report criterion with evidence; use headings and readable tables.
Grading	Report: 100 points plus the listed report bonus (up to 5). Video: 100 points. Together this project is 20% of the course; report and video each contribute 10%.
Rubric	The report and pitch criteria in this document are the canonical rubrics; the general assignment guide links here.
Finished when	The report PDF opens, the video plays with accessible permissions, names are included, all required fields are submitted, and each member has saved their contribution record.

Submission fallback: If SkillSimm prevents access or submission, save the shared document as a PDF and submit the report/video through the existing HuskyCT assignments by their current deadlines. Include contribution notes and report the technical issue to the instructor. Do not wait for a team workspace to reopen to preserve your work.

Existing work: These clarifications do not add requirements or shorten deadlines for already-submitted work. Work completed under earlier published guidance will be reviewed against that guidance where versions differ.

Build on Your Analysis and Strengthen Your Startup Plan

For the final project, continue working with the **same team and startup plan** you selected for the midterm. Use your research, instructor feedback, and course concepts to refine the venture and explain how it could enter the market, compete, and operate sustainably.

The final includes a **100-point report (up to 5 report bonus points)** and a **100-point pitch video**. Your team will submit the completed report and a final pitch video.

1. Continue your shared report

Use the same Google Doc as the midterm. Add Part 2 below Part 1, and revise the earlier material in response to feedback. Use team chat to coordinate changes and keep the report consistent.

Team role	Final responsibility
Team Leader	A: Incorporate Midterm Comments and Restate the Idea; review and submit the full report
Member 1	B: Market Deployment and Dominant Design
Member 2	C: Technology Deployment and Competitor Analysis
Member 3	D: Pricing Strategy
Member 4	E: Financial Budgeting
Entire team	Create the final pitch video

Each member should complete their assigned section and submit their task in SkillSimm with a brief, accurate contribution summary. This summary records individual contributions when edits in the shared Google Doc appear as "Anonymous."

The Team Leader's submission task unlocks after all four members have submitted. Before submitting, the leader should review the complete document and coordinate any final edits. **When the leader submits in SkillSimm, the system captures a final PDF and closes the project run.** Before closing the run, also save a PDF copy yourself. The Team Leader uploads the final report PDF and the team pitch video (or its working link) to the existing Blackboard assignments; those submissions are the versions used for grading.

See the Midterm Project Instructions for the original plan options and Part 1 requirements.

2. Final report — 100 points

A. Incorporate Midterm Comments and Restate the Idea — 10 points · Team Leader

1. Review every midterm comment. Make the suggested revision or explain why your team chose a different approach.
2. Restate the business idea and customer problem to reflect your updated thinking.
3. Read Part 1 from beginning to end and revise it into a cohesive document with a consistent voice.
4. Proofread for grammar, spelling, and formatting consistency.

B. Market Deployment and Dominant Design — 15 points · Member 1

1. Analyze how the venture would enter the market.
2. Discuss dominant design—the design or approach that becomes widely accepted in a market—or relevant industry standards.
3. Explain the challenges the venture may face in gaining market adoption.

C. Technology Deployment and Competitor Analysis — 25 points · Member 2

1. Describe the technology or operating capabilities the venture needs.
2. Compare the venture with competitors using publicly available evidence.
3. Identify what differentiates the venture and the risks it faces.

D. Pricing Strategy — 25 points · Member 3

1. Explain the proposed pricing model.
2. Compare alternative pricing approaches.
3. Discuss the trade-offs among growth, revenue, and profitability.

E. Financial Budgeting — 25 points · Member 4

1. Present the core cost and revenue assumptions.
2. Include a basic financial budget or projection.
3. Explain financial risks and uncertainties.
4. Classify spending as **committed** (obligations already made), **sticky** (difficult to reduce quickly), or **flexible** (easier to adjust). Explain the cost of stopping each type of spending.

Bonus — up to 5 points

- **Up to 2 points:** Include a primary-source interview, with consent and appropriate attribution.
- **Up to 2 points:** Support your analysis with a comparison to a real, documented case.
- **Up to 1 point:** Provide especially clear writing or strong data-based evidence.

3. Final pitch video — 15 min 100 points

Work together to create and submit one final pitch video that presents your improved venture and explains the decisions behind your recommendations. Organize your pitch into the following four parts, worth **100 points in total**:

1. **Market Deployment and Dominant Design — 25 points.** Explain which customer segment you will target first, how you will reach those customers, and how you will encourage adoption. Discuss the dominant design or industry standards relevant to your venture and explain how they affect your market entry decisions. Points are assigned for a practical market entry approach (10 points), an explanation of relevant dominant designs or standards (10 points), and a feasible response to adoption barriers (5 points).
2. **Technology Deployment and Competitor Analysis — 25 points.** Describe the technology and operating capabilities needed to deliver your solution, including what must be built, acquired, or provided by partners. Compare the venture with competitors using publicly available evidence, and explain why customers would choose your offering. Points are assigned for a feasible technology deployment approach (10 points), an evidence-based competitor comparison and clear differentiation (10 points), and an explanation of key technology or competitive risks and your response (5 points).
3. **Pricing Strategy — 25 points.** Present your proposed price and pricing model, explain why they fit your target customers, and compare them with credible alternatives. Use research or competitor pricing to support your recommendation, and explain the trade-offs among customer adoption, revenue, and profitability. Points are assigned for a clearly specified pricing model and price (10 points), an evidence-based comparison of alternatives (10 points), and a convincing explanation of the trade-offs behind your choice (5 points).
4. **Financial Budgeting — 25 points.** Present a readable budget or projection showing expected revenue, major costs, and the resulting profit or loss over a clearly stated period. Explain the assumptions behind your figures and how changes in sales or costs could affect the venture. Distinguish committed, sticky, and flexible spending, including the cost of stopping each. Points are assigned for a coherent budget with explicit revenue and cost assumptions (10 points), an assessment of financial risks and their effects on the projection (10 points), and a clear classification of spending and stopping costs (5 points).

Use clear audio and readable visuals throughout. Keep all figures consistent with your final report, and make sure factual claims and comparisons can be traced to evidence in that report.

4. Research and sources

The guidance below applies to both the midterm and final. Use evidence to test the plan's assumptions and support your proposed improvements.

Start with the supplied plan

The supplied plan for your chosen venture in this folder is your primary source for the original proposal. Cite it by section number so readers can locate the claims you discuss.

To develop an independent assessment, read the supporting details before the executive summary. Use this order:

1. **Appendix: Assumptions requiring validation** — What still needs to be tested?
2. **Appendix: Risk register** — What could prevent the venture from succeeding?
3. **Section 9: Financial plan** — Pay attention to footnotes, qualifications, and assumptions.
4. **Section 6: Operations** — What practical constraints must the venture address?
5. **Section 1: Executive summary** — How well do its claims align with the supporting details?

Reading in this order can help you identify gaps between the plan's overall claims and its underlying evidence. Explain those gaps constructively and recommend ways to address them.

Use outside evidence to test claims

- **Legal and regulatory sources:** Depending on the venture and its activities, investigate FERPA (34 CFR Part 99), COPPA (16 CFR Part 312), ADA Title II/III, Section 504, relevant accessibility standards such as WCAG, and applicable state recording and consent laws. For the email venture, consider GDPR and CCPA/CPRA as relevant. Explain which requirements apply and cite the original rule or authoritative source.
- **Competitors and comparable businesses:** Use SEC EDGAR to find filings. A comparable company's 10-K risk disclosures can help you identify risks to investigate. You may also draw on course cases, including TheRealReal, Affirm, Tesla, Cerebras, Snowflake, and Marvell.
- **Pricing and market claims:** Check competitors' public pricing pages, record the date, and save screenshots. Verify several competitor prices quoted in the plan and note any changes.

Learn from alumni interviews

UConn NetWerx can help you connect with alumni. Interviews provide firsthand perspectives that documents alone may not capture. Ask about challenges and trade-offs as well as successes. Obtain consent, take careful notes, and attribute insights appropriately in your report.

Additional resources

- UConn Entrepreneurship Business Plan Guide
- Reputable business reporting on market size and funding. Cite the outlet and date, distinguish reported estimates from audited figures, and use the evidence to check the plan's total addressable market (TAM) and serviceable available market (SAM) claims.

Feedback and revision record

Feedback identifies the report/video criterion, one specific strength, and one next revision. Keep a table with **comment → action taken → section/page**, or explain a reasoned decision not to make a suggested change. Use this record to prepare the final report's revision section.